

Principal Full Stack Engineer

CloudNative Labs — Empowering enterprises to build scalable, resilient cloud architectures with elegant, open-source-first solutions.

Location	San Francisco, CA (Remote-friendly)
Employment Type	Full-time
Compensation	\$280,000 - \$380,000 per year

The Opportunity

CloudNative Labs seeks an exceptional Principal Full Stack Engineer to join our platform architecture team. This is a high-impact leadership position where you'll define our organization-wide technical strategy, architect next-generation cloud infrastructure solutions, and mentor engineering teams across product domains. You'll work across the full stack—from TypeScript/React frontends to Node.js microservices to PostgreSQL databases—while establishing best practices and technical direction for our entire engineering organization. This role requires 12+ years of experience and a demonstrated track record of leading large-scale distributed systems and technical transformation initiatives.

About CloudNative Labs

CloudNative Labs is a B2B SaaS platform that provides enterprise-grade infrastructure orchestration and observability tools for companies managing distributed systems at scale. Founded in 2015, we serve Fortune 500 companies across financial services, e-commerce, and healthcare sectors. Our mission is to make cloud-native architecture accessible and manageable for organizations of all sizes. We employ 250+ engineers across 5 offices and are backed by Series C funding.

Day-to-Day

- Define and communicate org-wide technical strategy for cloud-native systems, including architecture decisions, technology choices, and long-term infrastructure roadmap
- Design and implement scalable full-stack solutions using Node.js, TypeScript, React, GraphQL, and PostgreSQL, setting architectural patterns that become standards across teams
- Lead cross-functional technical initiatives involving 3+ engineering teams, ensuring alignment with business objectives and platform scalability requirements
- Architect microservices patterns and distributed system designs on AWS/GCP, establishing deployment best practices and infrastructure-as-code standards using Kubernetes and Terraform
- Conduct technology evaluations and vendor assessments for mission-critical infrastructure decisions; establish guidelines for API design (REST/GraphQL), database scaling, and observability tooling
- Mentor and develop senior engineers and tech leads, including conducting technical reviews, architectural guidance, and career development planning
- Drive technical debt reduction initiatives and establish engineering excellence standards across codebases; establish code review practices and testing frameworks

- Represent engineering in executive strategy sessions; provide technical feasibility assessment for product and business roadmaps
- Lead high-impact projects from conception through delivery, ensuring technical rigor, performance optimization, and security compliance at every stage

You Have

- 12+ years of software engineering experience with at least 5+ years in full-stack distributed systems development
- Expert-level proficiency in TypeScript and modern Node.js ecosystems; proven ability to architect and scale backend systems
- Deep experience with React, frontend state management patterns, and building high-performance user interfaces at scale
- Advanced expertise with PostgreSQL and relational database design, including query optimization and scaling strategies
- Demonstrated experience architecting microservices on AWS or GCP, including Kubernetes orchestration, serverless patterns, and cloud-native deployment
- Proven track record of defining technical strategy and influencing engineering direction across multiple teams or organizations
- Strong systems design skills including REST and GraphQL API design, event-driven architectures, and asynchronous messaging patterns

Bonus

- Experience leading technical architectural reviews and establishing engineering standards across large organizations
- Expertise with observability platforms (Prometheus, Datadog, ELK stack) and distributed tracing tools
- Open-source contribution history or maintainership of infrastructure/developer tools projects
- Experience with infrastructure-as-code frameworks such as Terraform, CloudFormation, or Pulumi
- Track record of successful large-scale system migrations or major technical transformations
- Published technical writing, conference talks, or recognized thought leadership in cloud architecture or distributed systems

Our Stack



What We Offer

- Competitive equity package with refresher grants (0.25-0.5% depending on background)
- Comprehensive health coverage including medical, dental, vision for employee and dependents
- Unlimited PTO with minimum 15 days recommended; sabbatical program after 5 years
- Professional development budget of \$5,000/year for conferences, courses, and training
- Home office stipend (\$2,000) and annual hardware refresh allocation
- 401(k) matching (4% of salary) with immediate vesting

- Parental leave (16 weeks paid for primary caregiver, 8 weeks for secondary)
- Mental health support including therapy coverage and wellness platform

Apply

Submit your resume, a 1-2 page statement on your technical leadership philosophy, and GitHub/portfolio links to careers@cloudnativelabs.com with subject line 'Principal Full Stack Engineer Application.' Applications reviewed on rolling basis. Candidates will participate in a technical deep-dive, architectural discussion, and executive leadership alignment interview over 4-5 weeks.